

## Resume: Product Management Skills

| Skills sought within your field.                                                                                                                                      | Examples of how this skill can be demonstrated on a resume.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
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| <b>Strong Interpersonal Skills:</b> As a Product Manager, you will build relationships with stakeholders and influence others cross functionally.                     | <u>Education</u> <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• President or officer of a student group or club</li><li>• Alumni group leadership</li></ul> <u>Experience</u> <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Team experience (both in the workplace and/or outside of it)</li><li>• Led..., Partnered with..., Collaborated with..., Managed..., etc.</li><li>• Relationship development / management (i.e. Built / managed relationships...)</li></ul> <u>Additional</u> <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Civic involvement</li><li>• Team sports involvement</li></ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| <b>Analytical/Problem Solving Skills:</b> It is important to be able interpret quantitative data and employ the conclusions to organizational problems or challenges. | <u>Education</u> <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• A technical undergrad or Master's degree; high GMAT or GPA</li><li>• <i>Example:</i> Conducted feasibility study and evaluated growth opportunities for a non-profit organization, as part of the Business Consulting Group.</li></ul> <u>Experience</u> <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Modeling, data analysis, reviewed business plans, identified trends, etc.</li><li>• <i>Example:</i> Performed \$370M operational analysis at four facilities, which convinced client to reject \$7.5M in unprofitable contracts during bankruptcy</li><li>• Analyzed vertical markets, channel capabilities and trends through in-depth industry interviews resulting in the creation of strategic recommendations including new growth opportunities and e-business plan for wire and cable manufacturer</li></ul> <u>Additional</u> <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Competed in financial modeling competitions</li><li>• Completed financial modeling courses offered outside of Booth</li><li>• <i>Example:</i> Completed Data Analytic course on Coursera</li></ul> |

## Skills

| Skills sought within your field.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | Examples of how this skill can be demonstrated on a resume.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
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| <b>Verbal and written communication skills:</b> Used constantly to convey ideas, gain buy-in and persuade others. Used when leading teams/projects, writing reports and emails, working with customers, collaborating with team members, and presenting to senior management. | <u>Education</u> <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Counseled and mentored undergraduate students as a Career Advisor</li></ul> <u>Experience</u> <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Presented findings to senior management on the efficacy of training program, which resulted in a complete restructuring of program</li><li>• Directed all communications and briefings with Executive Committee on the project enabling improved coordination and database sharing across business units</li></ul> <u>Additional</u> <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Tutored adults in English as a Second Language (ESL) through the Wake County Literacy Council</li></ul>                                                                                                                                     |
| <b>Ability to execute/implement:</b> Results-oriented and proven ability to execute a project or strategy are important because a large part of the job is implementing and executing new initiatives/products.                                                               | <u>Education</u> <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Co-managed spring charity auction, resulting in a 30% increase in funds raised and \$42K donated to children's charities.</li></ul> <u>Experience</u> <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Increased cash flow by reducing accounts receivable cycle to 21 days, beating industry average by 25%.</li><li>• Increased sales 200% with key targeted accounts through developing product/service solutions and client relationship building.</li><li>• Led safety portion of team study on local Quality Control program and integrated findings into program redesign resulting in 40% performance improvement.</li></ul> <u>Additional</u> <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Organized environmental awareness programs for the Lions Club.</li></ul> |
| <b>Leadership:</b> ability to lead both people and projects by directing, influencing, prioritizing and motivating others. Try to emphasize your leadership experience in a business setting with an emphasis on cross-functional leadership.                                 | <u>Education</u> <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Co-chair of Chicago Women in Business group; led initiative to increase undergraduate women's awareness of MBA careers.</li></ul> <u>Experience</u> <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Led cross-functional team for TQM program; planned and executed plant-wide training series for 140 people.</li><li>• Managed a 26-person maintenance and operations division producing \$200M in annual revenue; division achieved 100% of production goals.</li></ul> <u>Additional</u> <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Committee co-chair of the Young Leadership Division of the Jewish Federation.</li><li>• Led community theatre's marketing efforts and increased subscriptions by 20% in two years.</li></ul>                                      |

## Attributes

| Attributes sought within your field.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | Examples of how this attribute can be demonstrated on a resume.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
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| <b>Entrepreneurial Attitude</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | <u>Education</u> <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Concentration in Entrepreneurship.</li><li>• Entrepreneurial activities (i.e. Member of EVC Group, SeedCon Volunteer, etc.).</li><li>• Self-study, created own major, started a new student group, activity, event, etc.</li></ul> <u>Experience</u> <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Started..., Created..., Founded..., Initiated..., etc.</li><li>• Developed a new process that didn't exist</li><li>• Include side-projects you initiated/participated in during your previous work.</li><li>• <i>Example:</i> Participated in the entire product design and go-to-market strategy phase of Cisco's flagship routing products</li></ul> <u>Additional</u> <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Founded a non-profit, started a small side business, etc.</li><li>• <i>Example:</i> Co-founded a non-profit group that supports private education scholarships for African students in the U.S.</li></ul> |
| <b>Comfort with ambiguity:</b> The ability to make decisions with limited information is a very important part of the Product Manager role. The examples don't necessarily have to show high impact decisions. They need to demonstrate the ability to manage uncertainty and make decisions without having complete information. | <u>Education/Additional</u> <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Won the Illinois college "best venture" award for creating a revolutionary business model for a new venture.</li></ul> <u>Experience</u> <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Made final capital equipment allocation decisions as part of an ad-hoc \$200MM M&amp;A deal.</li><li>• Led combat task forces of up to 20 people, tasked with executing highly important missions in unpredictable environments.</li></ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |

## Attributes

| Attributes sought within your field.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | Examples of how this attribute can be demonstrated on a resume.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
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| <p><b>Ability to work both in teams and individually:</b> as a Product Manager your work will involve being part of a team as well as working alone.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | <p><u>Education</u></p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Collaborated with classmates to evaluate business model and develop strategic marketing plan for Chicago Community Ventures, a non-profit business development organization, as part of the New Venture Lab</li> <li>• Elected by peers at Booth to participate in 2011 Leadership Challenge</li> </ul> <p><u>Experience</u></p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Independently created database to track user training process, enabling management to monitor productivity of sales staff and allowing sales staff to communicate best practices</li> <li>• Led 12-person process improvement team during cross department review; analyzed processes and coordinated activities throughout all offices</li> </ul> <p><u>Additional</u></p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Played Center on basketball team for three years through Chicago Sport and Social Club; completed 4 marathons and 1 triathlon</li> </ul> |
| <p><b>Enthusiasm for company/position/industry:</b> this is especially critical during the interviewing process. Employers want to know that you possess a sincere interest in their firm, their products, their customers and working for them specifically. Try to “tailor” your resume for the specific industry. Be prepared to answer the questions, “why this industry? Why this function? Why this firm?”</p> | <p><u>Education</u></p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Organized and facilitated panel discussion of <b>Biotechnology Industry</b> executives during Career Fair</li> <li>• Trained Japanese team to present their "<b>Education for Peace</b>" project, selected by audience as conference’s best presentation</li> <li>• Led Booth’s 2012 Retail Trek during winter break</li> </ul> <p><u>Experience</u></p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Modeled Israel’s largest capital reduction project: \$400MM dividend issuance for Israeli’s <b>biggest communication company</b></li> </ul> <p><u>Additional</u></p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Volunteer for the past three years at the annual conference for the <b>American Medical Association</b>.</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
| <p><b>Flexibility:</b> ability to wear many hats, taking on varying roles and responsibilities</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | <p><u>Education</u></p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Dual degrees or majors</li> <li>• Involved in extra-curricular and community activities</li> <li>• Worked through undergrad</li> </ul> <p><u>Experience</u></p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Moved through different divisions, locations, roles, etc.</li> <li>• Successful career change to a new industry</li> </ul> <p><u>Additional</u></p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Any additional activities unrelated to professional experience</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |

## Areas of Expertise

| Areas of expertise sought within your field.                                                                                                                                             | Examples of how this expertise can be demonstrated on a resume.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
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| <b>Technical background</b>                                                                                                                                                              | <u>Experience</u> <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Led 75-person division responsible for nuclear reactor operation, maintenance, training, and testing during nuclear reactor refueling and overhaul</li><li>• Oversaw vaccine production facility responsible for \$200M in sales; implemented cost savings initiatives leading to 10% reduction in variable costs</li></ul> <u>Additional</u> <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Assumed a management role in a volunteer capacity</li><li>• Founded a non-profit or led a successful fundraising effort for a cause</li></ul>                                                               |
| <b>Project management:</b> the ability to manage a project from start to finish; creating and meeting goals, and having the ability to organize people and resources to meet objectives. | <u>Experience</u> <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Oversaw team of 15 senior and junior consultants in the valuation department, advising the country's largest public companies.</li><li>• Led cross-functional product launch team responsible for introducing a plush panda co-branded with the World Wildlife Fund, resulting in sales of 4K units in the first three weeks</li></ul> <u>Additional</u> <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Led team of 20 volunteers responsible for raising money and organizing an annual state-wide music festival; raised more than \$50K and generated highest attendance in event's history</li></ul> |
| <b>Technology Experience / Passion for Technology</b>                                                                                                                                    | <u>Education</u> <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Bachelor of Computer Science</li><li>• Master of Engineering</li></ul> <u>Experience</u> <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Product development, product management, engineering</li><li>• <i>Example:</i> Led the design of Intel's Wireless Communications products...</li></ul> <u>Additional</u> <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Involvement in tech community (blog, Twitter feed, other social media)</li><li>• Coding experience</li></ul>                                                                                                                                     |